



KNIGHTS OF COLUMBUS

KEEP CHRIST IN CHRISTMAS



POSTER CONTEST GUIDEBOOK

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CONDUCTING A POSTER CONTEST

OVERVIEW

Conducting a Knights of Columbus Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest is a fun and easy way to put your faith into action and get youth in your community involved in their faith. It is fun to conduct because of the opportunity to witness the creativity and optimism of the youth in your community. It is easy because you can tap into existing structures like schools and do a lot of preliminary work. It can also provide excellent local, and potentially international, publicity for your council.

ORGANIZATION

The first step is to organize your contest. The councils, in consultation with the grand knight, should select a team that will administer the contest. This team will be involved in all phases of the contest: organization, publicity, judging, prizes, etc. The council should be “ready to go” right before the Christmas season by ordering kits no later than October 31. A suggested time frame would be for the students to complete work on their posters by December 1, with judging at the local level in place by December 31. District judging should be completed by January 15 with regional and jurisdictional judging completed by January 31. Entries for the international level of competition must be received at the Supreme Council office by February 28. International winners will be announced in March.

PUBLICITY

Once the team is in place, the next step is to contact Catholic schools, CCD classes and CYOs in your community to publicize your contest. Solicit the support of the teachers and administrators; ask them to encourage their students to participate. Teachers, school administrators, priests, sisters and Knights of Columbus officials may serve as judges. Try to include youth in the process of judging as well. Each entry should be the work of an individual student. Schools can use the contest as a project for art or religion classes.

If there are multiple schools participating, consider conducting preliminary judging. In this way, the people in the community that you ask to serve as judges, which should include youth, will not be overburdened with the volume of posters, and the judging process will proceed more quickly.

PROMOTE THE EVENT

Display promotional materials prominently. The posters included in the *Poster Contest Kit* should be displayed

prominently in the community. Provide contact information for a council member who is responsible for fielding inquiries about this contest. Supplement these posters with newspaper ads, radio and TV spots and other publicity. Additional posters are available free of charge through Supplies Online, the supply ordering portal available on Officers Online.

Build public interest in the contest. Get the word out about the contest in local newspapers, on the radio and by placing promotional posters in prominent places around town. Be sure to outline the criteria for judging and how to participate.

CRITERIA FOR JUDGING

Outline the criteria for your judges to use in rating the entries. The goal of this program is to increase the awareness of young people’s faith, while encouraging them to speak to other youth “in their own language” about the true meaning of Christmas. Meet with your judges in advance of the judging process so that all are “on the same page” regarding what to look for in a winning entry.

RECOGNITION

Recognize everyone participating by presenting the included participation certificates to all who submit entries and council champion certificates to your council’s winners. Encourage each school to develop some type of recognition for the winning artists in that particular school.

SUGGESTED TIMETABLE

Talk to your jurisdictional youth director to coordinate the deadlines in your jurisdiction.

Local — Councils should order their kits in September or October to be ready to present the contest by November. Posters should be completed by December 1, and the council judging should take place by December 31. Additional judging deadlines are as follows:

District — January 15

Regional — January 31

Jurisdictional — February 15

International — State councils must submit their winning entries to the Supreme Council no later than February 28. International winners will be announced approximately March 15.

RULES & REGULATIONS

TOPICS/CATEGORIES

Each poster must reflect the Keep Christ in Christmas theme with a visual image. There is no limit to the number of posters each contestant may submit.

ELIGIBILITY

The Knights of Columbus Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest is open to all youth between the ages of 5 and 14. Age eligibility is determined by the age of the contestant as of November 1.

AGE GROUPS

Contest entrants compete in one of three age groups — ages 5 through 7, ages 8 through 10 and 11 through 14. Some schools may have different age brackets for their elementary and middle schools. In these cases, it may be appropriate to group students by grade rather than age. Sponsoring councils should use their own judgment in deciding how to group participants. Each local, district, regional or jurisdictional competition may have up to 3 winning entries — a first and second place winner in each age group.

CONTEST LEVELS

The Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest can consist of up to five levels of competition: council, district, regional, jurisdictional and international. Below is a description of each to help you understand the progression of the program.

Council — This is the first level of the competition. Council officials should order the CPC-Kit, advertise through local media and contact schools to recruit contestants. The winning posters from the council-level competition are forwarded to either the district deputy or state council personnel, depending on the circumstances in your area.

District — The district level of the contest occurs ONLY if more than one council in the district participates in the Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest. Check with your district deputy to see if this is the case in your area. The winning posters for this level of the contest are forwarded to state program personnel for either the regional or jurisdictional competition. Check with your state poster contest chairman for the forwarding address and deadline for entries.

Regional/Jurisdictional — The regional level of competition usually only takes place in larger jurisdictions. In either case, schedule, judges and prizes are determined by the state council. Winning posters from the jurisdiction level must be forwarded to the Supreme Council office by February 15 for consideration at the international level.

Send jurisdiction-level winners' posters to:

Knights of Columbus
Fraternal Mission Department
C/O Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest
1 Columbus Plaza
New Haven, CT 06510-3326

AUTHORITY

The Knights of Columbus Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest will be under the authority of the state deputy. Local competitions are under the authority of the grand knight or program director. Any questions about this program should be directed to the appropriate local or jurisdiction officials.

RULES

Poster must reflect the theme of Keep Christ in Christmas.

Each poster should be the original work (including concept, layout, slogan and any visual images) of a single person.

Poster should be approximately 11x17 inches. However, the Supreme Council will not disqualify based on poster size. If pastels, chalk or charcoal are used, the poster must be laminated or covered with clear plastic.

Each poster must be submitted with a Knights of Columbus Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest entry form (#5025) — make sure your council number is included. The name and age of the entrant should be printed on the reverse side of the poster in case the poster and entry form get separated.

All entries become property of the Knights of Columbus Supreme Council office. Posters cannot be returned in most cases.

JUDGING, AWARDS & PUBLICITY

JUDGING

Judging teams should be composed of students, Knights, teachers, administrators, council chaplain, pastor, etc. A 100-point scoring system will be used to determine the winners.

Slogan — 30 Points:

How clearly is the theme presented?

Visuals — 30 Points:

How well do the visuals convey the message?

Overall Impact — 40 points:

How effective was the poster in capturing your attention and causing you to reflect on the topic at hand?

AWARDS

The following are suggestions for prizes to be awarded at the various levels of the Knights of Columbus Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest.

Local councils, districts and state councils can design their own awards for the contest — scholarships, gift certificates, saving bonds, plaques or trophies would all be acceptable.

Council — \$25-50 for the first place entry in each age group (5-7, 8-10, 11-14)

District — \$25-50 for the first place entry in each age group

Jurisdiction — \$50-100 for the first place entry in each age group

International — \$250 is awarded to the first place entry for each age group. Two runner-up prizes of \$100 each are also awarded for each group. All international winners receive a framed certificate signed by the supreme knight and the winning 11-14 category design will be used in the promotional poster for the contest next year.

PUBLICITY

A local council's successful participation in the Knights of Columbus Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest will depend on the support it receives from local private and parochial schools and the community. Before promoting the program in a school, permission and support must be obtained from the board of education, headmaster or principal. Also, you will need to advertise your contest through local media sources. Shown here is the suggested wording for a press release announcing the Knights of Columbus Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest and a letter promoting the event. This announcement and letter should be followed by a phone call to answer questions and provide additional information.

Kit Contents:

Participant Entry Forms/Judging Sheets, #5025

Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest Report Form, #5023

Council Winner Certificates, #5022

Participation Certificates, #5028

Keep Christ in Christmas Program Guide, #5024

Keep Christ in Christmas Promotional Posters, #5026

Order the program kit through Supplies Online, the supply ordering portal available on Officers Online.

KIT CONTENTS

These items can be ordered through Supplies Online,
which can be accessed in the Officers Portal.

KEEP CHRIST IN CHRISTMAS POSTER CONTEST
ENTRY FORM

I wish to enter THE KNIGHTS OF COLUMBUS KEEP CHRIST IN CHRISTMAS POSTER CONTEST in the age division specified by the following checkboxes:

☐ AGE 5-7 DIVISION ☐ AGE 8-10 DIVISION ☐ AGE 11-14 DIVISION

COUNCIL NUMBER _____

Name of Entrant _____ Date of Birth _____

Street Address _____ City _____

Telephone (Country) _____ Home _____ Cell _____ Email _____

Signature of Entrant _____ Parent/Guardian Signature _____

This Section To Be Completed By Parent/Guardian **Council No.** _____

I hereby certify that I am a parent or guardian of the entrant and agree to release the entrant from all liability for any injury or damage that may occur while participating in the contest. I also agree to indemnify and hold the Knights of Columbus harmless from all claims, damages, and expenses, including reasonable attorney's fees, that may be asserted against or incurred by the Knights of Columbus in connection with the entrant's participation in the contest. I understand that the entrant's participation in the contest is voluntary and that I am responsible for ensuring the entrant's safety and well-being at all times. I further agree to provide the entrant with appropriate supervision and care at all times. I understand that the Knights of Columbus are not responsible for any injury or damage that may occur while participating in the contest. I understand that the Knights of Columbus are not responsible for any claims, damages, and expenses, including reasonable attorney's fees, that may be asserted against or incurred by the Knights of Columbus in connection with the entrant's participation in the contest. I understand that the Knights of Columbus are not responsible for any injury or damage that may occur while participating in the contest. I understand that the Knights of Columbus are not responsible for any claims, damages, and expenses, including reasonable attorney's fees, that may be asserted against or incurred by the Knights of Columbus in connection with the entrant's participation in the contest.

This Section To Be Completed Knights of Columbus Officials **Score Sheet**

Competition Level	Signs - 30 points	Artistic Merit - 30 points	Overall Impact - 40 points
Council Level			
Diocese/Regional Level			
National Level			
International Level			

FAITH IN ACTION FAMILY

Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest
Entry Form
(#5025)

KEEP CHRIST IN CHRISTMAS POSTER CONTEST
PARTICIPATION REPORT FORM

Due By January 31

Immediately following the local contest, the Council Knight should complete and submit the Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest Participation Form (PPSC) to the Supreme Council Department of Pastoral Mission. This form provides the Supreme Council Office with valuable participation statistics as well as feedback about the program in general.

PLEASE INDICATE THE NUMBER OF PARTICIPANTS IN YOUR COUNCIL CONTEST:

AGE GROUP	5-7	8-10	11-14	TOTAL
GRADE	K-2	3-5	6-8	
TOTAL				

PERSONAL COMMENTS OR OTHER ITEMS CONCERNING THE KNIGHTS OF COLUMBUS KEEP CHRIST IN CHRISTMAS POSTER CONTEST

Signature _____ Date _____

COUNCIL NUMBER _____

CITY/TOWN _____

STATE/PROVINCE _____

FAITH IN ACTION FAMILY

Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest
Participation Report Form
(#5023)

KNIGHTS OF COLUMBUS
KEEP CHRIST IN CHRISTMAS POSTER CONTEST

The Knights of Columbus certifies

has participated in the
Keep Christ in Christmas
Poster Contest

Sponsored by _____

Council Knight _____ Date _____

FAITH IN ACTION FAMILY

Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest
Participant Certificate
(#5028)

KNIGHTS OF COLUMBUS
KEEP CHRIST IN CHRISTMAS POSTER CONTEST

The Knights of Columbus congratulates

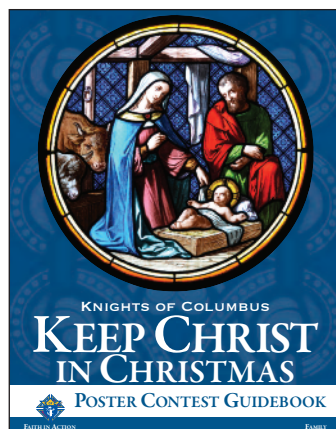
as a winner of the
Keep Christ in Christmas
Poster Contest

Sponsored by _____

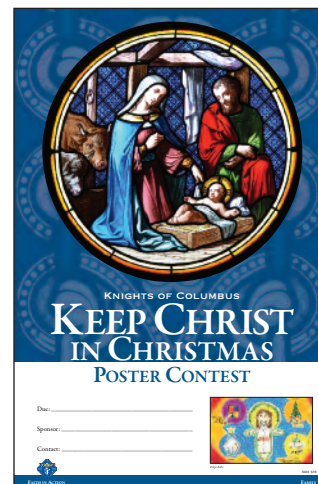
Council Knight _____ Date _____

FAITH IN ACTION FAMILY

Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest
Winner Certificate
(#5022)



Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest
Guidebook
(#5024)



Keep Christ in Christmas Poster Contest
Poster
(#5026)

NOTES

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KNIGHTS OF COLUMBUS
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203-752-4270 www.kofc.org